

Disability Medical Binder

A printable companion for organizing your medical documentation and advocacy

Full name _____

Date of birth _____

Phone _____

Email _____

Address _____

Date prepared _____

Motto (optional) _____

Example: "This body might bend, but it does not break."

Print single-sided and file in a 3-ring binder with tabbed dividers.

Front Matter: Personal and Contact Information

Quick-reference basics for anyone accessing the binder, such as doctors, family, or emergency responders.

Emergency Contacts

Contact 1

Name _____

Relationship _____

Phone _____

Contact 2

Name _____

Relationship _____

Phone _____

Contact 3

Name _____

Relationship _____

Phone _____

Primary Care Provider

Name and title _____

Clinic name _____

Clinic address _____

Phone _____

Front Matter: Personal and Contact Information (continued)

Specialty Providers

Provider 1

Provider or clinic name _____

Address _____

Phone _____

Services offered _____

Provider 2

Provider or clinic name _____

Address _____

Phone _____

Services offered _____

Insurance

Provider and plan _____

Member name _____

Member ID number _____

Member services phone _____

Crisis hotline _____

Prescription Rx (BIN / PCN / GRP) _____

Preferred Pharmacy

Name _____

Address _____

Phone _____

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Section 1: Diagnosed Conditions and Documentation

List confirmed diagnoses with evidence and real-world impacts to support disability claims.

Condition 1

Condition name

Date diagnosed

Supporting evidence

Impact on daily life

Condition 2

Condition name

Date diagnosed

Supporting evidence

Impact on daily life

Condition 3

Condition name

Date diagnosed

Supporting evidence

Impact on daily life

Examples (generic, for reference only):
Chronic back pain; Nerve pain in legs; Joint hypermobility; Migraine disorder; Mood disorder; Chronic abdominal pain; Low potassium; Elevated liver enzymes.

Tip: Use 1 to 2 pages per condition and include dates of diagnosis. Copy this page for additional conditions.

Section 2: Suspected and Undiagnosed Conditions

Document ongoing investigations or patterns suggesting undiagnosed issues.

Suspected condition 1

Condition name

Supporting evidence

Impact on daily life

Suspected condition 2

Condition name

Supporting evidence

Impact on daily life

Examples (generic, for reference only):
Suspected connective tissue disorder; Suspected autonomic dysfunction; Suspected small-fiber neuropathy; Suspected mast cell issues.

Tip: Note pending referrals or tests here, and update with new findings.

Section 3: Symptom Tracker Summary

Summarize symptoms by body system, including frequency, severity, and effects, based on logs from the past 1 to 2 years.

Example systems: musculoskeletal, neurological, cardiovascular and autonomic, cognitive, gastrointestinal, fatigue.

Body system 1

System name _____

Symptoms, with frequency and severity _____

_____

Functional impact _____

_____

Body system 2

System name _____

Symptoms, with frequency and severity _____

_____

Functional impact _____

_____

Body system 3

System name _____

Symptoms, with frequency and severity _____

_____

Functional impact _____

_____

Body system 4

System name _____

Symptoms, with frequency and severity _____

_____

Functional impact _____

_____

> **Tip:** Use a simple table or chart for trends; reference full logs if attached.

Section 4: Functional Impact Reports

Detail how conditions limit daily activities, with examples of frequency and severity.

Activities of Daily Living (ADLs)

Bathing/Showering	☐ Independent	☐ Needs tools	☐ Needs help
Dressing	☐ Independent	☐ Needs tools	☐ Needs help
Toileting	☐ Independent	☐ Needs tools	☐ Needs help
Grooming (hair/teeth)	☐ Independent	☐ Needs tools	☐ Needs help
Eating/Feeding	☐ Independent	☐ Needs tools	☐ Needs help
Walking/Transferring	☐ Independent	☐ Needs tools	☐ Needs help
Getting in/out of bed	☐ Independent	☐ Needs tools	☐ Needs help

Describe needs and examples, such as "Requires shower chair on bad days due to fall risk."

Section 4: Functional Impact Reports (continued)

Detail how conditions limit daily activities, with examples of frequency and severity.

Instrumental Activities of Daily Living (IADLs)

Meal preparation	☐ Independent	☐ Needs tools	☐ Needs help
Housekeeping	☐ Independent	☐ Needs tools	☐ Needs help
Laundry	☐ Independent	☐ Needs tools	☐ Needs help
Shopping	☐ Independent	☐ Needs tools	☐ Needs help
Transportation/Driving	☐ Independent	☐ Needs tools	☐ Needs help
Managing medications	☐ Independent	☐ Needs tools	☐ Needs help
Managing finances	☐ Independent	☐ Needs tools	☐ Needs help
Using communication devices	☐ Independent	☐ Needs tools	☐ Needs help

Section 5: PT and OT Strategies

Outline self-managed exercises, tools, and habits for mobility and pain.

Mobility and joint support

Notes

Stretching and pain management

Notes

Occupational therapy techniques

Notes

Mind-body practices

Notes

Exercises by body area

Notes

Safety tips

Notes

Tip: Include diagrams or photos of exercises; note modifications for flares.

Section 6: Symptom Catalog by Category

Comprehensive list of all symptoms, grouped for quick reference.

Musculoskeletal

-
-

Neurological

-
-

Autonomic and Cardiovascular

-
-

Cognitive and Mental Health

-
-

Gastrointestinal and Nutritional

-
-

Fatigue and General Systemic

-
-

Dental

-
-

Vision

-
-

Gynecological

-
-

Section 7: Treatment History

Track past and current interventions for continuity of care.

Current Medications

Medication	Reason prescribed	Dose and frequency	Dates and status

Past Medications

Medication	Reason prescribed	Why stopped

Medication Allergies

Example format: "[Medication] - [reaction]"

Medication or substance	Reaction

Therapies and Counseling

Therapy	Provider	Notes

Devices and Equipment

Items

Alternative and Holistic Treatments

Items

Lifestyle Adaptations

Items

> **Tip:** Use a timeline or table; note dates and outcomes.

Section 8: Nutrition Planning and Challenges

Address eating barriers and strategies for energy and weight management.

Nutritional challenges

Notes

Nutritional goals

Notes

Foods well tolerated

Notes

Foods causing flares

Notes

Nutrition strategies

Notes

Section 9: Assistive Tools and Daily Living Aids

Inventory of gear for independence.

Orthopedic and Mobility Aids

Item	How I use it	Where to get it

Pain and Fatigue Support Tools

Item	How I use it	Where to get it

Adaptive and Occupational Support Aids

Item	How I use it	Where to get it

> **Tip:** Add photos or sources; categorize by use, such as daily versus flares.

Section 10: Day in the Life

Narrative snapshot of a typical day to humanize impacts.

Morning (5:30 AM to 9:30 AM)

Symptoms, routines, adaptations

Midday (9:30 AM to 2:00 PM)

Symptoms, routines, adaptations

Afternoon and evening (2:00 PM to 7:00 PM)

Symptoms, routines, adaptations

Night (7:00 PM to bedtime)

Symptoms, routines, adaptations

Reflection

Personal quote on resilience

> **Tip:** Write in first person; update seasonally.

Section 11: If Found Unresponsive

Emergency protocol for responders.

> **Print this page on colored paper and keep it at the front of your binder.**

Basic Information

Name _____

Date of birth _____

Phone _____

Address _____

Emergency Contacts

Name and phone _____

Name and phone _____

Medical Notes

Example: "No spinal manipulation"

Key risks _____

Medications and Allergies of Note

Current status _____

Preferred Hospital or Provider

Name _____

In Case of Confusion

Example: "Brain fog is my baseline, not intoxication"

Notes _____

Mental Health Context

Notes _____

Optional Add-Ons

Extra sections for a fuller picture; add what serves you.

Family Medical History

Maternal and paternal patterns, by relative: conditions, symptoms.

Notes

Personal Values and Approach to Healing

Philosophy, humor, needs for support.

Notes

Data Visuals

Symptom correlation summaries, if tracked digitally.

Notes

General Tips for Building Your Binder

- **Length:** 30 to 40 pages; use dividers and tabs.
- **Updates:** Review quarterly; date your revisions.
- **Digital backup:** Scan to PDF for sharing with providers.
- **Customization:** Tailor to your conditions, such as adding sleep or sensory sections.
- **Resources:** Consult disability advocates or templates from organizations like the EDS Society.